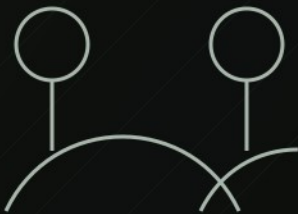


SIH INTERNAL HACKATHON 2026

TIT OFFICIAL RULEBOOK

From problem statement to national nomination

EVENT DATE: 09-09-26



FORM THE TEAM



DESIGN THE SOLUTION



PITCH & QUALIFY

Official SIH 2026 Problem Statements • 2–6 Members • 1+ Female Member Mandatory

About Tripura Institute of Technology

Tripura Institute of Technology (TIT), Narsingarh, Agartala, supports practical engineering, multidisciplinary innovation, entrepreneurship, and student-led problem-solving.

About Smart India Hackathon

Smart India Hackathon (SIH) encourages students to develop practical solutions for problem statements contributed by ministries, government departments, industries, and other organizations.

About SIH Internal Hackathon 2026 - TIT

SIH Internal Hackathon 2026 - TIT is the institute-level evaluation and selection round for teams working on official SIH 2026 problem statements. Eligible teams pitch before an appointed jury for recognition and possible national nomination.

Key Objectives

- Encourage students from different years and branches to solve real-world problems collaboratively.
- Identify practical, innovative, scalable, and socially relevant solutions from TIT.
- Strengthen solution design, presentation, teamwork, and Q&A skills.
- Select high-potential teams for institutional SIH 2026 nomination.

RULEBOOK STATUS: This document governs the TIT internal round. Mandatory official SIH 2026 rules and central-portal requirements will prevail wherever applicable.

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EVENT AT A GLANCE: 09-09-26 | 2-6 members | At least one female member | 5-minute pitch + 3-minute Q&A

1. About the Internal Hackathon

- 1.1. The event shall be known as SIH Internal Hackathon 2026 - TIT.
- 1.2. The internal hackathon is open to eligible students of Tripura Institute of Technology and serves as an institutional innovation, evaluation, and SIH nomination platform.
- 1.3. Teams shall work on one official SIH 2026 problem statement and pitch their proposed solution to the appointed jury.
- 1.4. The internal round shall assess the quality of problem understanding, innovation, proposed solution, feasibility, impact, presentation, and responses during Q&A.
- 1.5. There is no fixed institutional cap on the number of eligible teams that may register before the announced deadline.
- 1.6. Participation does not automatically guarantee nomination to the national SIH process. Nomination depends on ranking, eligibility verification, institutional approval, and official SIH portal limits.

Event Snapshot

Item	Rule
Eligible institution	TIT students only
Team size	Minimum 2; maximum 6 students
Female representation	At least one female student is mandatory
Problem statement	One official SIH 2026 problem statement per team
Pitch slot	8 minutes: 5-minute pitch + 3-minute Q&A
Presentation format	Official PPT template provided on the event platform

2. Eligibility and Team Formation

General Eligibility

- 2.1. Students from any year and any branch of TIT may participate, subject to the programme-level team formation restrictions below.
- 2.2. Diploma students may form teams only with other Diploma students.
- 2.3. B.Tech students may form teams only with other B.Tech students.
- 2.4. Diploma and B.Tech students shall not be combined in the same team.
- 2.5. Within the same programme level, students from different years and branches may collaborate. A team may also consist of students from a single branch.
- 2.6. Inter-college teams are not permitted. Every team member must be a currently enrolled TIT student at the time of registration and presentation.

Team Composition

- 2.7. A team shall consist of a minimum of 2 and a maximum of 6 students for the internal round.
- 2.8. Every team shall include at least one female student member. This requirement is mandatory.
- 2.9. Every team shall appoint one member as Team Leader. The Team Leader shall act as the primary contact and shall be responsible for registration, official communication, presentation submission, and certificate distribution.
- 2.10. A student may be a member of only one team and may participate under only one problem statement.
- 2.11. All members shall contribute meaningfully and work collaboratively. The jury may direct questions to any team member.

Organizer Participation and Conflict of Interest

- 2.12. Members of the organizing team may participate as competitors.
- 2.13. A participating organizer shall disclose their team membership and shall not handle judging assignments, confidential submissions, scores, result compilation, appeals, or decisions affecting their own team.

3. Problem Statement Selection

- 3.1. Each team shall select exactly one problem statement from the official SIH 2026 portal: <https://www.sih.gov.in/sih2026PS>.
- 3.2. Teams may select an eligible Software, Hardware, or Student Innovation/Open Theme problem statement available on the official portal.
- 3.3. The problem statement ID, title, category, and proposing organization shall be entered accurately during registration and shown consistently in the presentation.
- 3.4. A team shall not present an unrelated solution or change its registered problem statement without prior written approval from the authorized technical coordinator.
- 3.5. Teams are responsible for reading the complete official problem statement, expected outcomes, constraints, and any supporting documents before designing their solution.

4. Competition Structure

Phase	Activity	Applies To	Outcome
1	Team registration	All teams	Registration received
2	Eligibility and data verification	All registered teams	Eligible team list
3	Presentation submission/readiness	Eligible teams	Pitch-ready teams
4	5-minute pitch + 3-minute Q&A	All pitch-ready teams	Jury scores
5	Ranking, recognition, and nomination review	Eligible evaluated teams	Top 3, Ignite Prize, nomination decision

Phase 1 - Registration

- 4.1. The Team Leader shall complete the official registration form before the announced deadline and shall enter the Coordinator Referral Code obtained from the Technical Lead.

Phase 2 - Verification

- 4.2. The organizing team shall verify team composition, student details, duplicate membership, problem statement details, and completeness of the registration.

Phase 3 - Presentation Readiness

- 4.3. Eligible teams shall prepare their pitch using the official PPT template issued through the event platform and follow all file submission and reporting instructions.

Phase 4 - Jury Presentation

- 4.4. Each team shall receive 8 minutes in total: 5 minutes for presentation and 3 minutes for questions and answers.

Phase 5 - Results and Nomination

- 4.5. Jury scores shall be consolidated, eligibility shall be reverified, and the Top 3 teams and special-award recipient shall be announced on the presentation day, where operationally feasible.

5. Registration and Verification

- 5.1. Only the Team Leader may register the team.
- 5.2. The Team Leader shall submit accurate names, roll numbers, programme, branch, year, contact details, problem statement information, and any other required data for every member.
- 5.3. The Coordinator Referral Code is mandatory and may be obtained from the Technical Lead.
- 5.4. Duplicate, incomplete, false, misleading, or unverifiable registrations may be rejected.
- 5.5. The Team Leader shall verify the spelling of every name before submission because certificate data may be generated from the submitted information.
- 5.6. A successfully submitted registration may remain provisional until eligibility verification is completed.
- 5.7. Where correction is permitted, the Team Leader shall complete it within the deadline communicated by the organizers.

6. Presentation and Pitching

Duration	Segment	Minimum Coverage
5 minutes	Team pitch	Problem context; users/stakeholders; proposed solution; innovation; technical approach; feasibility; impact; implementation plan.
3 minutes	Jury Q&A	Technical reasoning, assumptions, feasibility, originality, risks, scalability, team contribution, and expected outcomes.

- 6.1. Teams shall use the official PPT template provided on the event platform. Changing the prescribed structure or using an unauthorized format may result in correction instructions or a penalty.
- 6.2. The moderator may stop the presentation when the allotted time expires. Content presented after time expiry may not be considered.
- 6.3. The presentation shall remain aligned with the registered problem statement and shall not contain misleading, plagiarized, unlawful, or unverifiable claims.
- 6.4. Teams shall report at the announced time and keep the final presentation ready in the required file format. Late arrival may affect the presentation slot.
- 6.5. The jury may question any member. Teams are expected to demonstrate shared understanding rather than relying only on the Team Leader.

PITCH CONTROL: Five minutes means five minutes. Teams should rehearse with a timer and prioritize the problem, solution, innovation, feasibility, and impact.

7. Evaluation and Selection

The appointed jury shall evaluate each eligible team using a common institutional rubric. Final score weights or score sheets may be issued separately before judging.

Criterion	What the Jury May Evaluate
Problem Understanding	Clarity, relevance, stakeholder need, constraints, and evidence that the team understands the selected problem.
Innovation and Originality	Distinctiveness of the concept, feature set, technical approach, process, or value proposition.
Proposed Solution	Completeness, appropriateness, logical design, user experience, and alignment with the expected outcome.
Technical Feasibility	Architecture, tools, resources, implementation plan, risks, testing approach, and realistic deliverability.
Impact and Scalability	Expected benefit, adoption potential, sustainability, affordability, reach, and possibility of scaling.
Presentation and Teamwork	Structure, communication, visual clarity, time management, collaboration, and contribution across members.
Question and Answer	Accuracy, confidence, transparency, reasoning, depth, and ability to respond to concerns or limitations.

Selection Rules

- 7.1. Judges shall assign points independently or through the approved evaluation process and may record comments for consolidation.
- 7.2. A strong presentation alone shall not compensate for an irrelevant, copied, unsafe, or technically unrealistic solution.
- 7.3. Eligibility verification may be completed before or after scoring. An ineligible team shall not receive final ranking or nomination.
- 7.4. In the event of a tie affecting an award or nomination, the jury may consider higher performance in innovation, feasibility, and Q&A, or may conduct an additional tie-break question/review.
- 7.5. The consolidated decision of the jury, subject to institutional verification, shall be final for the internal ranking.

8. Timeline and Official Communication

Milestone	Tentative Status
Registration opens	25-08-2026
Registration deadline	03-09-2026
Eligibility verification	05-09-2026
PPT template	Through event platform
Presentation day	09-09-26
Top 3 and special award result	Presentation day
Portal certificates	After processing on the event portal
SIH nomination formalities	As communicated by the institute/SPOC

- 8.1. The event platform and notices issued by authorized coordinators are the official sources for schedules, venue, reporting time, referral code, PPT format, results, and certificate updates.
- 8.2. Teams are responsible for monitoring official communication and meeting all deadlines. Organizers may revise schedules for administrative, academic, technical, or participation-related reasons.

9. Awards and Recognition

Recognition	Details
₹6,000 Total Cash Prize	Official cash pool for the Top 3 teams: ₹3,000 for 1st Prize, ₹2,000 for 2nd Prize, and ₹1,000 for 3rd Prize.
1st Prize - Winner	₹3,000 cash prize, Winner Trophy, certificates, Certificate of Excellence from IIC-TIT, and direct SIH 2026 nomination.
2nd Prize - 1st Runner-Up	₹2,000 cash prize, Runner-Up Trophy, certificates, Certificate of Excellence from IIC-TIT, and direct SIH 2026 nomination.
3rd Prize - 2nd Runner-Up	₹1,000 cash prize, Merit Trophy, certificates, Certificate of Excellence from IIC-TIT, and direct SIH 2026 nomination.
Participation Certificate	Eligible participating teams and registered members receive participation recognition as described in Section 10.
Ignite Prize	One standout team may receive a 1-month OpenAI ChatGPT Go subscription for unique innovation, based on the jury's selection.

- 9.1. The Ignite Prize is independent of the Top 3 ranking and may be awarded to any eligible team for standout innovation.
- 9.2. The ChatGPT Go subscription includes enhanced message and tool limits, image generation, and reasoning access, subject to availability, account eligibility, and applicable OpenAI plan terms.

10. Results, Certificates, and SIH Nomination

- 10.1. The Top 3 final result shall be announced on the presentation day, subject to completion of evaluation and verification.
- 10.2. A Team Participation Certificate shall be issued to eligible participating teams on the presentation day, where operationally feasible.
- 10.3. Individual Participation Certificates for registered members shall be made available through the event portal. The Team Leader shall download and distribute the certificates to team members.
- 10.4. Certificate issuance may be withheld or corrected where registration data is inaccurate, duplicated, or under verification.
- 10.5. Internal teams may contain **2-6 members**. A team selected for the national SIH process shall be finalized to exactly 6 members on the central portal, subject to official SIH requirements.
- 10.6. The institute/SPOC may nominate teams up to the permitted official limit. Event guidance indicates that up to 50 internal teams may be considered for nomination; the actual number remains subject to SIH 2026 portal rules and institutional approval.
- 10.7. A nominated team shall complete all central-portal formalities, verification, and member-detail requirements within the communicated deadline.

11. Deliverables

Stage	Required Deliverable
Registration	Completed team registration, verified member details, problem statement information, and Coordinator Referral Code.
Presentation readiness	Official PPT template completed with the registered problem statement and team details.
Pitch day	Final presentation file and any permitted supporting prototype/demo material.
Nomination, if selected	Exactly 6 eligible members and all information/documents required by the official SIH central portal.

- 11.1. Files shall follow the naming convention, format, size limit, and submission method communicated by the organizers.
- 11.2. Teams remain responsible for retaining a backup copy and confirming that the submitted file opens correctly.

12. Conduct and Academic Integrity

Professional Conduct

- 12.1.** Participants shall behave respectfully and professionally toward other teams, judges, volunteers, organizers, and institute staff.
- 12.2.** Harassment, abusive conduct, disruption, intimidation, cheating, or deliberate interference with another team is prohibited.

Academic and Technical Integrity

- 12.3.** Ideas, slides, prototypes, code, datasets, media, and supporting materials shall be used lawfully and with appropriate permission, attribution, or licensing.
- 12.4.** Plagiarism, fabricated results, false claims, impersonation, or misrepresentation of another person's work may result in disqualification.
- 12.5.** Use of AI tools is permitted only when consistent with institute instructions, applicable licenses, privacy and security requirements, and honest disclosure when asked. The team remains responsible for accuracy, originality, and consequences.

Safety and Privacy

- 12.6.** Teams shall follow venue safety instructions. Organizers may stop any unsafe hardware, electrical, chemical, mechanical, wireless, or software demonstration.
- 12.7.** Teams shall not expose personal data, confidential institute information, credentials, unsafe access methods, or data collected without authorization.

13. Disqualification and Organizer Authority

A team may be rejected, penalized, or disqualified for any of the following:

- Ineligible or unverifiable participants.
 - Violation of the programme-level team rule, team size, female-member requirement, TIT-only requirement, or one-student-one-team policy.
 - Duplicate, incomplete, fraudulent, or misleading registration data.
 - Failure to use the official presentation format or comply with event instructions and deadlines.
 - Plagiarism, misconduct, unsafe activity, manipulation of judging, or conflict-of-interest abuse.
 - Violation of applicable law, institute policy, or mandatory official SIH rules.
- 13.1.** Questions or disputes shall first be submitted through the official channel announced by the organizing committee.
 - 13.2.** The institute may verify facts, seek clarification from the team or judges, correct administrative errors, and issue a final determination.
 - 13.3.** If this rulebook conflicts with a mandatory official SIH 2026 requirement, the official SIH rule shall prevail for nomination and central-portal submission.
 - 13.4.** Prize amounts, allocation, nomination capacity, certificates, and subscription benefits remain subject to eligibility, official rules, availability, and final organizer confirmation.

Annexure A: Registration Checklist

- All members are enrolled TIT students.
- All members belong to the same programme level: Diploma-only or B.Tech-only.
- The team has 2-6 members.
- At least one female student is included.
- No member is registered with another team.
- One official SIH 2026 problem statement has been selected.
- Problem statement ID and title are accurate.
- Names and roll numbers are correctly spelled.
- The Coordinator Referral Code has been obtained from the Technical Lead.
- The Team Leader has reviewed the complete form before final submission.

Annexure B: Pitch Checklist

- The official PPT template is used without unauthorized structural changes.
- The opening clearly states the problem statement and target user/stakeholder.
- The proposed solution is explained in simple language.
- Innovation and differentiation are specific, not generic claims.
- Technical architecture or workflow is understandable.
- Feasibility, resources, implementation plan, and risks are addressed.
- Expected impact and scalability are explained.
- The team has rehearsed the pitch within 5 minutes.
- Every member can answer questions about the solution.
- A final PPT backup is available in the required format.

FINAL CHECK: Correct team. Correct problem statement. Official template. Five-minute pitch. Three-minute Q&A. Honest and collaborative presentation.

Official Contact and Updates

Item	Details
Technical Head Lead	Manjit Chakraborty
Registration Link	https://titinternalsih.vercel.app/index.html
Registration Deadline	03-09-2026
Event Date and Venue	09-09-26 Venue: To Be Announced
Official SIH PS Portal	https://www.sih.gov.in/sih2026PS